

info sheets

Is this the future we dreaming of?

This Was Tomorrow: Is This the Future We Were Dreaming Of? is a long-term audio-visual investigation by artist and photographer Enrico Policardo into community-led housing across the UK - cohousing, Community Land Trusts, cooperative living, retrofit and repair.

It looks at places that are functioning in the present, without framing them as models or solutions. The question throughout is not "does this work?" but something closer to: what futures are still imaginable from where we are now?

The work began in 2022, with the fundamental input of architectural historian Judith Martin, documenting endangered council estates in London and the utopian ideals held in their concrete. A residency at ESAD IDEA in Porto, made possible by David Marques (Devity Studio), shifted the focus - from documenting past utopias to watching the present, and asking why we seem to have lost the postwar momentum that once drove us to build, to house, to look at the future with pragmatism and hope.

This phase turns to what people are doing now, from the bottom up - not waiting for the institutions once meant to enable and protect them, but acting for themselves. The aim was never to document these places from the outside, but to distil, in images and voices, what moved such different people into action - and to carry some of their energy and their dreams to you.

Places and voices

The photographs presented shown without the people who live in these places; their voices are kept separate, and never explain the image. Beside each print, an A4 sheet tells you about that place, with a QR code to listen to the people there. A second code opens the quote generator - lines drawn at random from all the interviews. Scan, listen, read, in any order. You do the rest.

This work has been made possible by Arts Council England through the Developing Your Creative Practice (DYCP) scheme, and supported by Simon Vickery (Open House Festival Programme Manager), writer and photographer Thaddeus Zupancic (London Estates: Modernist Council Housing 1946-1981), and architectural historian Judith Martin, co-author of the original This Was Tomorrow publication.

This Was Tomorrow grew out of an earlier iteration and two editions of a book of the same title.

For more info please visit

thiswastomorrow.co.uk
enricopolicardo.com

Quote Generator

Scan the QR code
for the quote
generator; a webpage
that pulls a random
quote from across
all the interviews.



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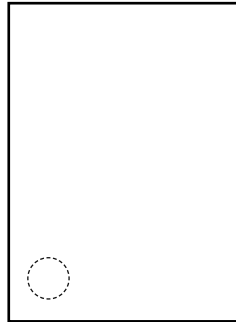
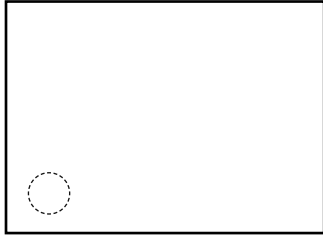
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Cressingham Gardens

Lambeth, London • visited 03/2026



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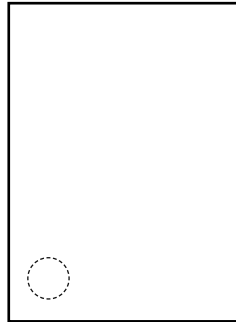
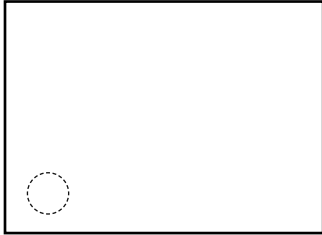
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Hastings Commons

Hastings, East Sussex • visited 04/2026



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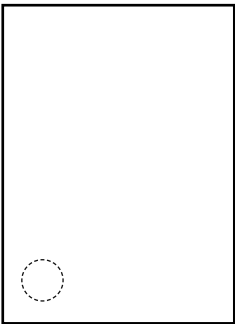
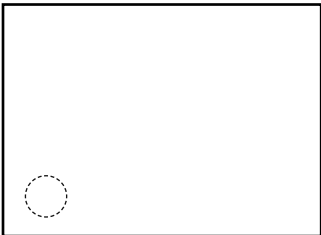
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Tinker's Bubble

Norton Sub Hamdon • visited 04/2026



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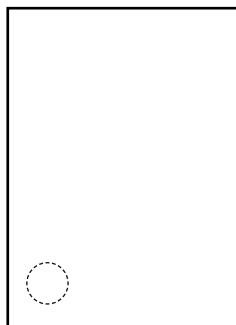
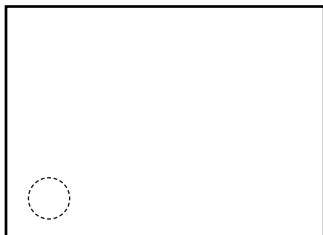
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Kitty's Laundrette

Anfield, Liverpool • visited 05/2026



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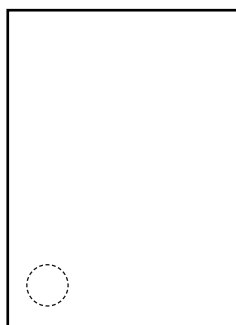
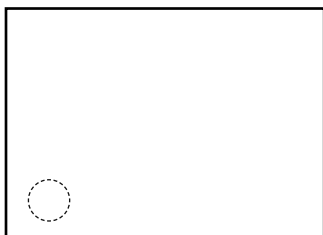
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Two Up Two Down

Anfield, Liverpool • visited 05/2026



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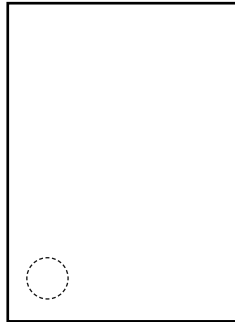
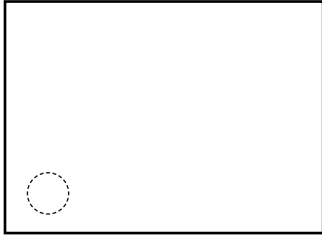
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Granby Four Streets Community Land Trust

Toxteth, Liverpool • visited 05/2026



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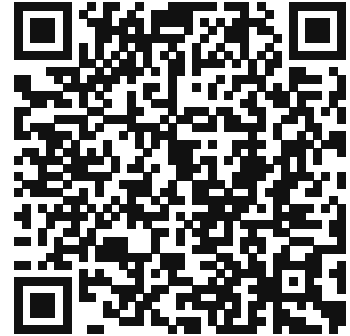
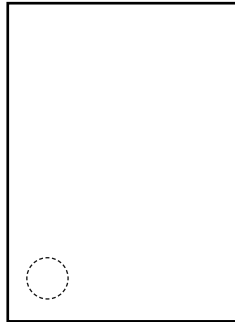
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Calder Valley Community Land Trust

Hebden Bridge & Todmorden, Yorkshire • visited 05/2026



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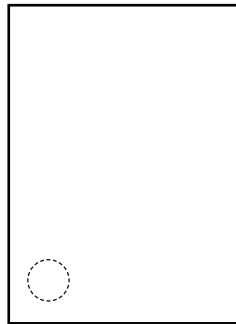
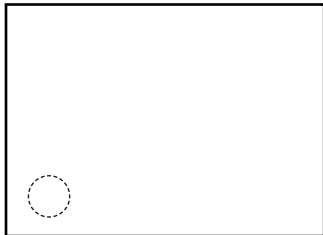
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LILAC

Low Impact Living Affordable Community

Leeds, Yorkshire • visited 05/2026



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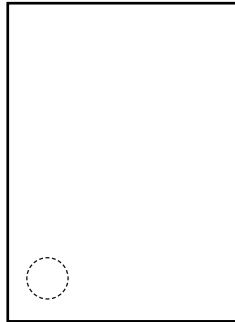
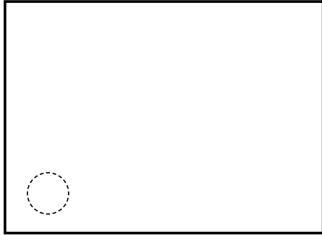
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New Ground Cohousing

High Barnet, London • visited 04/2026



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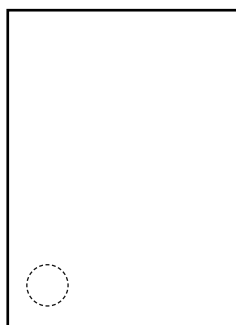
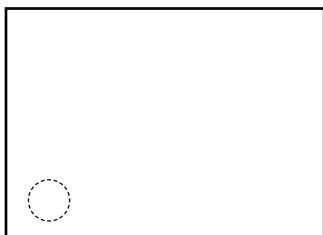
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Trevone Quarry

Penryn, Cornwall • visited 06/2026



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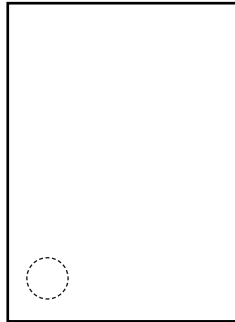


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Kesoberi Community

Paul, Cornwall • visited 06/2026



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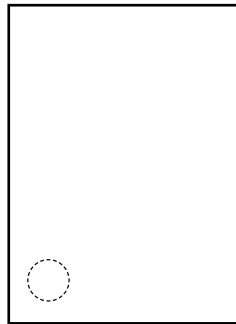
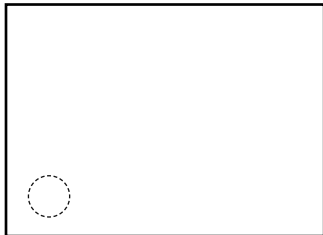
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Treneere Estate Whole Again Community

Penzance, Cornwall • visited 06/2026



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